

	Division/Section	Family Support
	Chapter No./Name	4 – Economic Stability (ES)
	Part No./Name	P – Strategies to Empower People (STEP) Program
	Section No./Name	P-300-STEP Case Management Process
	Document No./Name	P-330-STEP Assessments
	Effective Date	February 15, 2024

I. STATEMENT OF POLICY

* Family Assessment

A Family Assessment shall be completed with all work-eligible STEP participants in order to assist the STEP Coach in identifying strengths, challenges, interests, skills, prior work experience, and level of employability.

The Family Assessment provides a snapshot in time of what is going on with a participant, their family, and their individual circumstances. It's used to gather information on what activities will be most helpful to the participant and aids in developing their Family Success Agreement (FSA) Rights and Responsibilities and Family Success Agreement (FSA) Goal Plan. **

Unless Good Cause is verified, failure to complete the Family Assessment will result in a STEP sanction. (Refer to P-500-STEP.)

* STEPping Stones to Success

The STEPping Stones to Success shall be used to help STEP Coaches facilitate first-time conversations and follow-up conversations with the participant, in relation to their motivation and readiness to participate. **

II. PROCEDURES

* Family Assessment

The Family Assessment is divided into various sections and topics to support a conversation between the STEP Coach and participants to determine the best engagement pathway.

The Family Assessment is designed to:

- allow the participant to indicate their values, goals, strengths, and potholes;
- engage the participant;
- develop a relationship with the participant;
- learn about the family's current needs and challenges;
- guide conversations with families;
- determine needed programs, services, and referrals; and
- gather information to establish family goals and action plans.

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It gives the STEP Coach the flexibility to select a starting topic when engaging the participant in a comprehensive discussion. The conversation must flow based on family needs and goals. The participant's response is the starting point of the conversation. This format supports a fluid and meaningful conversation with the participant. The STEP Coach must: **

- * use open-ended questions, where the participant has the opportunity to do most of the talking;
- use active listening skills and focus on the participant's interests, goals, strengths, and challenges; and
- engage the participant in a conversation around goals, services, supports, and referrals.

Some examples include:

"I see you feel *Frustrated* about your current situation. Do you mind telling me more so that I can better understand?"

"I see you would feel successful if STEP helped you *Develop healthy relationships*. What relationships would you like to improve? Why is that important to you?"

"I see you have a personal goal *To further your education*. What type of education are you interested in?"

The following section includes topics that the STEP Coach should touch upon during the comprehensive discussion based upon the participant's responses on the Family Assessment form:

Family Situation

When exploring the family's current situation, the STEP Coach should consider what services, supports, or exemptions may be needed.

Employment & Work Experience

Based upon the participant's response, the STEP Coach should explore the participant's current employment circumstances and work history/experience.

Education & Training

Based upon the participant's interest, the STEP Coach should explore education and training experience, along with related goals and interest in pursuing this as an engagement activity.

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Financial Literacy

Financial literacy services and supports can provide families with the tools for a smoother transition from a benefit-based income to a wage-based income, and keep them from unknowingly entering into financially devastating credit arrangements. It is an essential element to a family achieving financial stability, self-sufficiency, and economic mobility.

Based upon the participant's interest, the STEP Coach should make a referral to training available in the participant's local community.

Family Violence

Based upon the participant's response, the STEP Coach must use the LITE Domestic Violence Questionnaire to further explore any issues that the participant is willing to discuss. The Domestic Violence Questionnaire provides a mandatory script and questions to support screening participants for family violence.

The STEP Coach must provide referral information to the participant, when needed.

Domestic Violence help is available if services are needed:

- Louisiana Statewide Hotline. Free. Confidential. 1.888.411.1333
- National Domestic Violence Hotline 1.800.799.SAFE (7233)
- Text "START" to 88788

Sexual Assault help is available if services are needed:

- Louisiana Statewide Hotline: Speak to an Advocate at 1.888.995.7273
- Text an Advocate 1.225.351.SAFE (7233)
- National Hotline: 1.800.656.HOPE (4673)

Substance Abuse

If the participant discloses that they or a family member have a substance abuse addiction, the STEP Coach must explore whether a referral for a chemical dependency assessment and support is needed.

The FITAP/STEP Regional Consultant can help get the participant connected to services, if the STEP Coach and Supervisor needs assistance.

Emotional, Medical, and Health

Based upon the participant's response, the STEP Coach must explore whether a referral to social or medical services is needed to professionally assess and support the family's

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emotional, medical, or health circumstances. If the STEP Coach is unsure, they must conference with the Supervisor to make the determination. The STEP Coach should also be assessing whether medical documentation is needed to support exemption, if appropriate based upon the family's reported circumstances.

Housing

Based upon the participant's response, the STEP Coach should explore the family's housing situation to determine how it may impact the participant's engagement in activities.

Transportation

Based upon the participant's response, the STEP Coach should explore the participant's current means of getting around and whether the transportation stipend is needed to enable the client's participation.

Legal Issues

Based upon the participant's response, the STEP Coach should explore any legal issues the participant is facing that could affect activity engagement and/or employment opportunities.

Other Agencies

Based upon the participant's response, the STEP Coach should explore and document the agencies or programs the participant is already engaged with.

The STEP Coach must use all of the information gathered to determine if the participant is job ready or not, and consider how to best help them achieve their goals.

The Family Assessment is located on the TuaPath home page under **My Pathway > Step 4: Tell us more about you!** This step contains the Family Assessment form and STEPping Stones to Success survey.

The Family Assessment form may be completed in TuaPath by the participant, or by the STEP Coach if completed face-to-face or by phone.

The STEP Coach must conduct the Family Assessment comprehensive discussion with the participant during the initial appointment prior to or in conjunction with the completion of the Family Success Agreement.

The STEP Coach must document the Family Assessment comprehensive discussion in LITE Person Notes.

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STEPping Stones to Success

STEPping Stones to Success presents a broad view of the participant's strengths and needs. Having a better sense of where participants are starting and the urgency of the challenges they face can help STEP Coaches identify and prioritize which services and opportunities participants may be encouraged to pursue. But Stepping Stones is more than that. It also gives participants a way to reflect on their current circumstances and inform the STEP Coach how motivated they are to take action and how prepared they feel they are to take action. **

III. FORMS AND INSTRUCTIONS

There are no forms associated with this policy.

IV. REFERENCES

Code of Federal Regulations, Title 45: [Parts 261, 262, 263, and 265](#)

Reauthorization of TANF Final Rule [\[Federal Register: February 5, 2008 \(Volume 73, Number 24\)\]](#)
[Act 58, 2003 Reg. Session.](#)

[LAC 67:III.5719](#)